

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 01

Shah Jahan: visible magnificence, managed strain

1 1628-1658: succession, expansion and courtly sovereignty

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Read two axes together: visible capacity and hidden mismatch

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Core lens: ruling class, mansab, jagir, jama and succession

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 FACT / ANALYSIS discipline; no automatic decline story

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Verified PYQ status and workbook use

A search of local CSE 2018-2025 official/OCR papers and all available routing ledgers found no direct verified Prelims or GS-I PYQ owned by this Topic 21 cluster: Shah Jahan's ruling class, month-scale, du-aspa sih-aspa, jagir-jama-hasil, Shahjahanabad or the 1657-58 transfer. No direct PYQ is therefore simulated, and no unofficial answer is labelled official. The following 80 MCQs and 10 Mains questions are original practice. They use strict independent A-B-C-D rotation in each set.

PART I - EVIDENCE BANKS FOR ANSWER WRITING

Bank 1. The reign as visible capacity plus managed strain

Start a response by rejecting a false choice. Shah Jahan's reign does show material capacity: the Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Jama Masjid and Shahjahanabad required central coordination of workshops, labour, material and ritual. It also reveals a service system managing a gap between assessed claim and effective receipt. The month-scale is evidence of adjustment, not an instant collapse. Use the source-bound jama index (100 in 1595, about 122 in 1627, about 176 in 1656-57) only as an assessed-revenue index; it is not GDP, cash or welfare. The Mains move is claim -> named monument/index -> mechanism -> qualification: court splendour does not prove universal prosperity, and fiscal pressure does not erase state capacity.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 02

Chronology 1627-1658

1

1628 accession; early revolts test the settlement

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

1633 Ahmadnagar; 1636 Deccan settlement; 1638 Shahjahanabad

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

1646-47 Balkh; 1649 Qandahar loss; 1656-57 renewed Deccan pressure

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

1657 illness -> 1658 contested succession and deposition

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 2: Chronology 1627-1658

Visual 2: Chronology 1627-1658. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Golden age versus strain matrix

1 Visible: territory, court, monuments, high ceremonial order

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Hidden: assessed versus realised revenue and growing claims

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Do not equate court abundance with universal prosperity

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Verdict: peak capacity can coexist with managed fiscal strain

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 3: Golden age versus strain matrix

Visual 3: Golden age versus strain matrix. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Jama index: source-bound trend

1 Repository Satish Chandra extract: 100 (1595)

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 about 122 (1627)

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 about 176 (1656-57)

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Assessed revenue index: not GDP, actual cash or a welfare series

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 35: Jama index: source-bound trend

Visual 35: Jama index: source-bound trend. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Fiscal squeeze as a system

1 Rank promise + cavalry obligation + jagir availability

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Assessment, collection and transfer mediate the promise

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 An adjustment can keep the system working now

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Managed strain is not identical to later full jagirdari crisis

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 38: Fiscal squeeze as a system

Visual 38: Fiscal squeeze as a system. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Bank 2. Elite composition and the recruitment mechanism

Define ruling class before listing groups. It is the high mansabdar/service elite attached to appointment, jagir, command, household access and imperial favour. Turanis, Iranis, Hindustani Muslims, Rajputs, Afghans, Deccanis and limited Maratha entrants are historically meaningful but overlapping categories. Use the direction of widening Indian participation without an uncited percentage. Rajput participation works through particular houses, honour and service. Shahji Bhonsale works as a bounded example of elite movement. Formal non-heredity coexists with social reproduction through families, clients and court knowledge. This gives an answer both integration and competition rather than ethnic determinism.

What 'Mughal ruling class' means

1 High mansabdars and service elite around the emperor

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Rank, jagir, household, command and access are linked

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Not a modern bourgeois class; not one ethnic bloc

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Formal appointment meets informal family and patronage capital

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 7: What 'Mughal ruling class' means

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 08

Composite nobility: a service coalition

- 1 Turanis and Iranis remain important migrant/service categories

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

- 2 Hindustani Muslims and Shaikhzada lineages supply local links

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

- 3 Rajputs, Afghans, Deccanis and some Maratha entrants widen the field

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

- 4 Categories overlap, change and cannot predict loyalty

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 8: Composite nobility: a service coalition

Visual 8: Composite nobility: a service coalition. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 10

Recruitment and advancement channels

- 1 Imperial favour + military competence + administrative usefulness

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

- 2 Household ties, kinship, recommendation and patronage

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

- 3 Regional knowledge and frontier networks can be assets

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

- 4 This is not a modern open competitive civil service

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 10: Recruitment and advancement channels

Visual 10: Recruitment and advancement channels. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Formal non-heredity, social reproduction

1 Mansab and jagir are imperial grants, not automatic inheritance

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Families retain contacts, training, clients and court familiarity

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Kinship can ease entry without creating a legal right

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Distinguish formal rule from lived reproduction of elite advantage

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 11: Formal non-heredity, social reproduction

Visual 11: Formal non-heredity, social reproduction. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Diversity: integrative strength and competitive risk

1 Strength: wider talent, local mediation, multiple military networks

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Risk: rivalry for rank, jagir and princely access

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 A faction is a patronage coalition, not an ethnic destiny

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Succession converts normal competition into high-stakes alignment

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 12: Diversity: integrative strength and competitive risk

Visual 12: Diversity: integrative strength and competitive risk. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Rajput participation: hierarchy, honour and service

1 Kachhwaha and other houses obtain rank, honour and command

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Kinship, court presence and service integrate selected houses

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Participation varies by house, period and political calculation

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Avoid 'all loyal' and 'all excluded' simplifications

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 13: Rajput participation: hierarchy, honour and service

Visual 13: Rajput participation: hierarchy, honour and service. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Maratha and Deccani entry: bounded incorporation

1 Deccan commands require local knowledge and mobile military labour

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Shahji Bhonsale's service is a specific elite case

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Limited elite entry is not mass Maratha integration

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Later Shivaji and jagirdari crisis are Topic 23 territory

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 14: Maratha and Deccani entry: bounded incorporation

Visual 14: Maratha and Deccani entry: bounded incorporation. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Bank 3. Mansab, verification and fiscal vocabulary

The fastest technical sequence is: mansab -> zat/sawar -> dagh/chehra -> du-aspa sih-aspa -> jagir -> jama/hasil -> month-scale. Zat is status/pay grade and sawar the cavalry obligation. Dagh/chehra have Alauddin-Sher Shah-Akbar provenance; they checked but did not end fraud. Du-aspa sih-aspa under Jahangir increased specified cavalry duty without raising zat. Jagir is a revenue assignment, not land ownership; khalisa is crown revenue. Jama is assessment and hasil realisation. The month-scale translates a paper annual entitlement into an effective month rating, affecting support for pay and remounts. Always state that a nominal rank is not necessarily an effective troop count.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 15

Mansab recap: rank connects status, pay and service

1

Akbar's mature dual-rank framework: c.1595-96

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Zat: personal status and pay grade

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Sawar: stipulated cavalry obligation

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Mansab is neither a land title nor a modern job grade

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 15: Mansab recap: rank connects status, pay and service

Visual 15: Mansab recap: rank connects status, pay and service. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 16

Zat versus sawar: the Prelims discriminator

1

Zat answers: who is the officer in hierarchy?

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Sawar answers: what cavalry obligation is specified?

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Numbers may differ; the two fields are not synonyms

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Rank on paper does not itself prove effective troop presence

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 16: Zat versus sawar: the Prelims discriminator

Visual 16: Zat versus sawar: the Prelims discriminator. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 17

Dagh and chehra: provenance and purpose

1

Alauddin Khalji used branding and descriptive control

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Sher Shah revived/adapted controls in his context

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Akbar systematised them for the Mughal framework

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Purpose: verify animals/persons, not invent cavalry from nothing

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 17: Dag and chehra: provenance and purpose

Visual 17: Dag and chehra: provenance and purpose. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 18

Du-aspa sih-aspa under Jahangir

1

Specified sawar obligation could be doubled or tripled

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Zat does not rise merely because extra horse obligation appears

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

It increases the military claim within the service arrangement

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Do not say it doubled the noble's entire rank

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 18: Du-aspa sih-aspa under Jahangir

Visual 18: Du-aspa sih-aspa under Jahangir. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Muster and evasion loop

1 Dagh + chehra -> inspect horses and descriptive rolls

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Noble presents men/animals -> official verifies

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Borrowed horses or temporary troops can evade a snapshot audit

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Controls reduce fraud; they do not make record and reality identical

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 22: Muster and evasion loop

Visual 22: Muster and evasion loop. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Jagir vocabulary map

1 Jagir: assignment of state revenue claim, not land ownership

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Jagirdar: assignee; zamindar: local superior/intermediary category

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Khalisa: revenue reserved for the crown

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Watan jagir / inam / madad-i-maash: compare only with context

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 23: Jagir vocabulary map

Visual 23: Jagir vocabulary map. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Jama versus hasil

1 Jama: assessed or estimated revenue demand

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Hasil: realised collection

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Gap can emerge from bad assessment, war, resistance or collection cost

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Jama index is not GDP, total cash income or peasant welfare

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 26: Jama versus hasil

Visual 26: Jama versus hasil. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Month-scale mechanism

1 Nominal jama -> expected annual assignment

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Actual/estimated effective yield -> month rating

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Salary and service claims are scaled to that rating

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 It is an adjustment for mismatch, not an award or bonus

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 29: Month-scale mechanism

Visual 29: Month-scale mechanism. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

12-, 8-, 6-, 5/4-month ladder

1 12 months: nominal full-year equivalent

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 8/6/5/4: shortfall expressed as usable months

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Deccan cases may be rated 3-4 months in the cited source

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Use each example only with its accounting context

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 30: 12-, 8-, 6-, 5/4-month ladder

Visual 30: 12-, 8-, 6-, 5/4-month ladder. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Pay and contingent scaling

1 Repository source records Rs 40 / 30 / 25 per month in its cited example

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 The figures concern a sawar-pay illustration, not every noble's income

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Lower effective value constrains remount and troop maintenance

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Quote the source and category; never universalise the figures

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 31: Pay and contingent scaling

Visual 31: Pay and contingent scaling. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Bank 4. Deccan, campaigns, succession and source criticism

Deccan examples reveal the expansion paradox: 1633/1636 offer real Mughal gains, but high jama might not become high effective yield. Explain low ratings through war, terrain, control, survey and collection; use the source-bound three-to-four-month Deccan cases carefully. Balkh and Qandahar test logistical sustainability. The 1657 illness and 1658 succession contest show how noble patronage becomes violent under uncertainty; factions are shifting alignments, not fixed ethnic camps. For sources, Padshahnama gives court claim/appointment; tables give nominal patterns; monuments give material sovereignty; travellers provide situated observations. Triangulate.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 40

Deccan jagir field - SCHEMATIC NOT TO SCALE

1

North: imperial revenue core and court

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Deccan: forts, routes, sultanates and local intermediaries

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Distance, season, fodder and control condition collection

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Map is an analytical field, not a modern boundary

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 40: Deccan jagir field - SCHEMATIC NOT TO SCALE

Visual 40: Deccan jagir field - SCHEMATIC NOT TO SCALE. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 41

Campaigns and state-capacity pressure

1

1633/1636 Deccan: settlement and deployment

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

1646-47 Balkh: temporary military success, poor sustainability

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

1649-53 Qandahar: loss and failed recovery attempts

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Rank rewards and logistics translate campaigns into fiscal claims

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 41: Campaigns and state-capacity pressure

Visual 41: Campaigns and state-capacity pressure. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 42

Balkh and Qandahar: boundary of capacity

1

Balkh: campaign succeeds tactically but is abandoned

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Qandahar: Safavid loss in 1649; recoveries fail

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Fort, climate, distance and supply matter

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Do not attach invented campaign expenditure totals

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 42: Balkh and Qandahar: boundary of capacity

Visual 42: Balkh and Qandahar: boundary of capacity. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY 21 | VISUAL 49

1657 illness: succession trigger

1

No primogeniture rule guarantees transfer

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Illness creates uncertainty over access, command and reward

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Princes mobilise regional bases and noble support

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Contested sovereignty is institutional vulnerability, not instant collapse

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 49: 1657 illness: succession trigger

Visual 49: 1657 illness: succession trigger. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Succession alliances: patronage under uncertainty

1 Nobles calculate survival, reward, access and military context

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Princely households create competing nodes

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Affiliation changes; no rigid ethnic voting bloc

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 War exposes factional risk in an otherwise integrative elite system

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 51: Succession alliances: patronage under uncertainty

Visual 51: Succession alliances: patronage under uncertainty. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Succession battle chronology

1 1658 Dharmat -> Samugarh

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 1659 Khajwa and Deorai belong to the extended consolidation

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Murad Bakhsh is removed; Shah Jahan remains confined

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Military victory and legal-institutional succession are distinct

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 52: Succession battle chronology

Visual 52: Succession battle chronology. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Faction is not ethnicity

1 Patronage ties cut across origin labels

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Military opportunity and court access alter alignment

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Avoid Turkani-versus-Irani or Hindu-versus-Muslim master keys

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Ask which prince, reward and moment instead

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 54: Faction is not ethnicity

Visual 54: Faction is not ethnicity. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Source-reach matrix

1 Padshahnama: ceremony, campaigns, appointments and legitimation

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2 Administrative tables: pattern, but nominal/category limits

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3 Travellers: observation with outsider/comparative bias

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4 Architecture: material capacity and ideology, not a fiscal ledger

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 58: Source-reach matrix

Visual 58: Source-reach matrix. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

Court chronicle, record and monument

1

Chronicle explains what court wished to foreground

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

2

Record traces administrative categories and claims

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

3

Monument makes sovereignty material and visible

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

4

Triangulate; none separately gives total social reality

Use as an answer-writing evidence cue.

Original deterministic study visual | Dates and quantities follow the source-risk notes in this package.

Visual 60: Court chronicle, record and monument

Visual 60: Court chronicle, record and monument. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE.

PART II - ORIGINAL MCQ PRACTICE WITH SOLUTIONS

Learning MCQ loop - original (correct options A-B-C-D x5)

Q1. Which statement best defines a Mughal jagir in this topic?

- A. A transferable assignment of a state revenue claim linked to service B. Unrestricted private ownership of a province
C. A hereditary village office held by every zamindar D. A cash pension unrelated to military obligations

Answer: A. A transferable assignment of a state revenue claim linked to service

Explanation: The key discriminator is assignment of revenue claim rather than proprietary title; the land-ownership option is the classic translation error.

Q2. In the mature Akbari dual-rank framework, zat primarily expressed:

- A. the actual annual hasil of a jagir B. personal status and the related pay grade C. a prince's territorial base D. the number of months for which a jagir yielded revenue

Answer: B. personal status and the related pay grade

Explanation: Zat is a hierarchy-and-pay field. Sawar, not zat, is the field that connects a mansab to cavalry obligation.

Q3. What did the sawar component of a mansab specify?

- A. the noble's legal title to land B. the amount of jama retained as khalisa C. the stipulated cavalry obligation D. the crown's reserved revenue

Answer: C. the stipulated cavalry obligation

Explanation: Sawar concerns cavalry service. The khalisa option confuses crown revenue with a personal rank field.

Q4. Du-aspa sih-aspa, as placed in the assigned source tradition, is associated first with:

A. Alauddin Khalji B. Shah Jahan C. Aurangzeb D. Jahangir

Answer: D. Jahangir

Explanation: The placement under Jahangir is the chronology test; Shah Jahan inherited and managed later adjustments rather than inventing this device.

Q5. The most careful reading of du-aspa sih-aspa is that it:

A. increased specified cavalry obligation without necessarily raising zat B. doubled every component of a noble's mansab C. converted jagir into hereditary property D. abolished branding of horses

Answer: A. increased specified cavalry obligation without necessarily raising zat

Explanation: It modifies specified military duty. The 'whole mansab doubled' lure ignores the separate zat and sawar fields.

Q6. Dagh and chehra are best understood as:

A. a pair of Shah Jahan's architectural offices B. branding and descriptive-muster controls intended to check fraud C. two categories of khalisa land D. titles for Rajput contingents

Answer: B. branding and descriptive-muster controls intended to check fraud

Explanation: Branding and descriptive rolls are verification devices. They did not guarantee that borrowed men or horses could never be presented.

Q7. Which provenance sequence is correct for dagh/chehra controls?

A. Akbar invented them; Jahangir abandoned them; Shah Jahan restored them B. Sher Shah invented them; Alauddin copied him; Akbar ended them C. Alauddin Khalji used them; Sher Shah revived/adapted them; Akbar systematised them D. Shah Jahan created them solely for Deccan warfare

Answer: C. Alauddin Khalji used them; Sher Shah revived/adapted them; Akbar systematised them

Explanation: The sequence guards against an Akbar-first or Shah Jahan-invented claim while preserving the difference between use and systematisation.

Q8. Jama is most accurately described as:

A. actual realised collection in every year B. a mansabdar's personal status rank C. a fortification assessment D. assessed or estimated revenue

Answer: D. assessed or estimated revenue

Explanation: Jama is an assessment claim; hasil is realised collection. Treating jama as cash in hand erases the fiscal problem the month-scale addresses.

Q9. Hasil refers to:

A. actual realised collection B. a nominal rank increase under du-aspa C. the crown's reserved revenue D. a city foundation process

Answer: A. actual realised collection

Explanation: Hasil is the realised side of the revenue vocabulary. Khalisa is crown-reserved revenue, not a synonym for collection.

Q10. The month-scale was designed principally to:

- A. grant a bonus to officers sent to difficult districts B. scale pay and service claims to a jagir's effective month rating
C. make every jagir a full twelve-month yield D. end all transfer of jagirdars

Answer: B. scale pay and service claims to a jagir's effective month rating

Explanation: It records and adjusts for a shortfall; it does not transform a weak yield into a reward or abolish imperial rotation.

Q11. The repository's cited Deccan three-to-four-month cases illustrate:

- A. that Deccan posts were uniformly the richest B. that jagirs became freehold estates C. a high assessed jama could coexist with a low effective return D. that Qandahar was a Deccan province

Answer: C. a high assessed jama could coexist with a low effective return

Explanation: The point is the jama-hasil mismatch under difficult conditions; 'richest posts' reverses the source-bound implication.

Q12. The source-bound jama series 100, about 122, about 176 should be used as:

- A. a count of mansabdars by reign B. a price series for marble C. a measurement of uniform peasant prosperity D. an index of assessed revenue claims, not GDP or actual cash

Answer: D. an index of assessed revenue claims, not GDP or actual cash

Explanation: It is an assessed-revenue index. The other readings add a denominator and meaning the source does not provide.

Q13. Which statement best captures Shah Jahan's fiscal condition?

- A. managed strain in a functioning system, not a completed later crisis B. a fiscally effortless golden age C. an empire already administratively collapsed in 1628 D. a system without any jagir mismatch before Aurangzeb

Answer: A. managed strain in a functioning system, not a completed later crisis

Explanation: The calibrated verdict holds resource pressure and functioning administration together; both extreme alternatives flatten chronology.

Q14. The standard chronology for Mumtaz Mahal's death is:

- A. 1630 B. 1631 C. 1638 D. 1658

Answer: B. 1631

Explanation: Use 1631. The assigned Part II note's 1630 printing is a documented source discrepancy/typo, not the standard fact.

Q15. Shahjahanabad's relevant date and caution are:

- A. 1649 foundation after Qandahar's loss; it was completed at once B. 1628 foundation before accession; it had no market life C. 1638 foundation/transfer process; it was not built in a single year D. 1658 foundation by Aurangzeb as a successor city

Answer: C. 1638 foundation/transfer process; it was not built in a single year

Explanation: 1638 anchors the project, while a process framing prevents the false image of an instantly completed city.

Q16. The 1646-47 Balkh venture is best summarised as:

A. permanent annexation that solved the northwest frontier B. a Deccan revenue settlement C. a campaign led after Shah Jahan's deposition D. temporary military success that proved strategically and logistically unsustainable

Answer: D. temporary military success that proved strategically and logistically unsustainable

Explanation: Balkh demonstrates that battlefield performance and sustainable possession differ; permanent annexation overstates the result.

Q17. Qandahar was lost to Safavid Persia in:

A. 1649 B. 1633 C. 1657 D. 1628

Answer: A. 1649

Explanation: 1649 is the required frontier date. 1633 belongs to Ahmadnagar's end, while 1657 is the illness trigger.

Q18. The 1657 illness matters because it:

A. automatically installed Dara Shukoh as constitutional heir B. activated a contest in a polity without a fixed primogeniture rule C. ended all provincial commands D. created a fixed Turani-Irani war

Answer: B. activated a contest in a polity without a fixed primogeniture rule

Explanation: The illness made access and reward uncertain; it did not supply an automatic legal succession or ethnic alignment formula.

Q19. A sound statement about Mughal noble composition is that:

A. all Rajputs held identical rank and loyalty B. foreign-born elites disappeared under Shah Jahan C. the Indian element broadened while immigrant groups remained important D. one exact percentage applies without date or denominator

Answer: C. the Indian element broadened while immigrant groups remained important

Explanation: The direction of change is supportable in the assigned notes; an unqualified percentage would pretend to data the package does not establish.

Q20. Shahji Bhonsale is used in this topic as:

A. proof of mass, stable Maratha incorporation B. the founder of Shahjahanabad C. a Safavid governor of Qandahar D. a bounded example of elite movement and service in the Deccan field

Answer: D. a bounded example of elite movement and service in the Deccan field

Explanation: His case shows selective elite incorporation; it cannot bear a claim about all Marathas or later Shivaji's full career.

Broad technical MCQs - original (correct options A-B-C-D x11)

Q21. Why can monuments be used as evidence for state capacity?

A. They show coordination of labour, materials, workshops and court demand B. They directly reveal the empire's annual cash balance C. They prove uniform rural prosperity D. They make administrative records unnecessary

Answer: A. They show coordination of labour, materials, workshops and court demand

Explanation: Monuments demonstrate mobilisation and ideology, not a complete fiscal ledger or social survey.

Q22. Which is the best distinction between jagirdar and zamindar?

A. Both are identical legal owners of all village land B. An imperial assignee differs from a locally rooted intermediary category C. A zamindar is always a transferable mansabdar D. A jagirdar is the same as khalisa

Answer: B. An imperial assignee differs from a locally rooted intermediary category

Explanation: Transferable imperial assignment versus rooted local claims is the core distinction; the other options collapse categories.

Q23. A short-rated jagir could encourage which response?

A. automatic abolition of cavalry obligations B. conversion of jama into hasil by definition C. competition for a better posting and pressure on local revenue channels D. end of all imperial dependence

Answer: C. competition for a better posting and pressure on local revenue channels

Explanation: Shortfall creates incentives around postings and collection; it does not magically convert assessment into cash.

Q24. Which factor is NOT sufficient by itself to explain inflated jama?

A. war and interrupted cultivation B. survey or assessment error C. distance and collection difficulty D. a universal assumption that every officer committed fraud

Answer: D. a universal assumption that every officer committed fraud

Explanation: Fraud may occur, but the package requires a multi-causal explanation including war, survey and control.

Q25. The 1636 Deccan settlement should be described as:

A. a temporary political framework, not total annexation of all Deccan states B. permanent incorporation of every Deccan polity C. a Safavid-Mughal treaty over Qandahar D. a post-1658 arrangement

Answer: A. a temporary political framework, not total annexation of all Deccan states

Explanation: It involved a bounded settlement with Bijapur and Golconda; total annexation is inaccurate.

Q26. Why do rank awards create fiscal pressure?

A. They automatically raise realised hasil B. They generate salary and service claims that need support C. They eliminate the need for jagirs D. They reduce the number of court households

Answer: B. They generate salary and service claims that need support

Explanation: A rank is a claim on remuneration and service support; it cannot itself increase collection.

Q27. A high sawar number should NOT be assumed to prove:

A. that a cavalry obligation existed B. that verification mattered C. that the stated number of troops was always campaign-effective D. that remount resources were relevant

Answer: C. that the stated number of troops was always campaign-effective

Explanation: Nominal obligation and actual force are distinct, which is why muster controls and evasion matter.

Q28. What does transfer of jagirdars seek to preserve?

A. hereditary provincial sovereignty B. permanent village ownership by assignees C. the abolition of central appointment D. imperial dependence and limits on local entrenchment

Answer: D. imperial dependence and limits on local entrenchment

Explanation: Rotation is a central lever, although it can also create short-term extraction incentives.

Q29. Court ceremony is relevant to political analysis because it:

A. orders access, precedence and the public image of sovereignty B. replaces military command and revenue C. establishes modern equality before law D. proves no noble bargaining occurred

Answer: A. orders access, precedence and the public image of sovereignty

Explanation: Ritual is political representation, not a substitute for all coercive and fiscal institutions.

Q30. The term 'composite elite' is strongest when it means:

A. a permanent ethnic federation with fixed voting blocs B. a coalition incorporating varied service networks under imperial appointment C. a modern representative legislature D. an elite without factional rivalry

Answer: B. a coalition incorporating varied service networks under imperial appointment

Explanation: Composite describes varied incorporation, not modern representation or an absence of competition.

Q31. The best reason to avoid an exact noble-composition percentage here is:

A. percentages are never useful in history B. all chronicles prohibit counting C. the package lacks a stated dataset, date, rank threshold and denominator D. Mansabs had no numerical rank

Answer: C. the package lacks a stated dataset, date, rank threshold and denominator

Explanation: Quantification is valid only when its population and method travel with it; the absolute ban and factual claims are wrong.

Q32. Khalisa revenue is:

A. a cavalry allowance within sawar B. a synonym for hasil C. a Rajput kinship tie D. revenue retained for the crown rather than assigned as jagir

Answer: D. revenue retained for the crown rather than assigned as jagir

Explanation: Khalisa concerns crown-reserved revenue. It is neither realised collection nor a personal rank.

Q33. A watan jagir should be handled as:

A. a context-specific locally/hereditarily associated grant category B. proof that every jagir was freely inheritable C. another name for du-aspa sih-aspa D. a universal cash salary

Answer: A. a context-specific locally/hereditarily associated grant category

Explanation: The term signals a different relationship but cannot erase the broader distinction between legal rule and local association.

Q34. Which is the safest inference from the 1657-58 war?

A. each origin group chose one prince permanently B. succession uncertainty made noble patronage calculations high stakes C. all state institutions ceased at illness D. primogeniture was violated

Answer: B. succession uncertainty made noble patronage calculations high stakes

Explanation: There was no fixed primogeniture rule to violate; the war reveals a vulnerable transfer mechanism, not ethnic determinism.

Q35. Dharmat and Samugarh belong to:

A. the 1636 Deccan settlement B. the 1646 Balkh expedition C. the 1658 phase of the succession struggle D. the 1649 Qandahar recovery

Answer: C. the 1658 phase of the succession struggle

Explanation: These battles are part of the 1658 contest, while the distractors shift them to unrelated campaign dates.

Q36. Khajwa and Deorai are useful here because they:

A. mark Shah Jahan's accession in 1628 B. are sites of the Taj Mahal C. ended Ahmadnagar in 1633 D. show that succession consolidation extended beyond the first 1658 battles

Answer: D. show that succession consolidation extended beyond the first 1658 battles

Explanation: They belong to the extended 1659 consolidation, avoiding the false impression that Samugarh alone ended every contest.

Q37. Which claim about architecture is methodologically weakest?

A. The Taj Mahal alone caused the later Mughal decline B. Monuments required coordinated resources C. Court demand could support craft markets D. Architecture expressed sovereignty

Answer: A. The Taj Mahal alone caused the later Mughal decline

Explanation: Single-cause decline claims cannot be inferred from a monument; the other statements make bounded evidence claims.

Q38. The Taj Mahal link to the reign should be dated with the correction that:

A. Mumtaz died in 1638 when Shahjahanabad was founded B. Mumtaz Mahal died in 1631 despite a 1630 typo in the assigned note C. the Taj is a Qandahar monument D. the tomb proves a 1658 accession

Answer: B. Mumtaz Mahal died in 1631 despite a 1630 typo in the assigned note

Explanation: 1631 is the standard date; the other answers attach the monument to unrelated dates or events.

Q39. What does the accessible SRDC Jama Masjid page safely provide for this export?

A. proof of a 2026 Mughal revenue policy B. a direct record of Shah Jahan's construction accounts C. a static urban-conservation comparison with no verified six-month dated CA anchor D. a current event that may be dated without checking

Answer: C. a static urban-conservation comparison with no verified six-month dated CA anchor

Explanation: The page describes precinct planning but lacks the qualifying date required for a fresh CA claim; it is retained only as a bounded static link.

Q40. Why are Padshahnama-style chronicles insufficient by themselves?

A. They contain no dates or appointments B. they are modern statistical surveys C. they are architectural plans D. They foreground courtly order and may be selective about suffering or failure

Answer: D. They foreground courtly order and may be selective about suffering or failure

Explanation: Court chronicles are valuable for ceremony and appointments, but genre and purpose limit their social reach.

Q41. Administrative tables require caution because:

A. nominal categories may not equal actual cash, troops or complete populations B. numbers can never be compared C. they eliminate all need for source criticism D. they are always traveller accounts

Answer: A. nominal categories may not equal actual cash, troops or complete populations

Explanation: Tables can reveal patterns, but category and survival limitations prevent a direct leap to actual force or income.

Q42. European traveller evidence should be used as:

A. a universal census of rural society B. a situated observation to be triangulated with other evidence C. a replacement for Persian chronicles D. a source that applies only before Akbar

Answer: B. a situated observation to be triangulated with other evidence

Explanation: Travellers offer observations filtered by position and comparison; they neither replace nor universally invalidate court sources.

Q43. What is the most accurate claim about Bernier in this topic?

A. He was a Padshahnama author B. his prose is an official revenue table C. His later observations cannot be transparently projected onto all of Shah Jahan's reign D. he proves every jagir failed

Answer: C. His later observations cannot be transparently projected onto all of Shah Jahan's reign

Explanation: Chronology and viewpoint limit Bernier's reach; he remains useful with explicit qualification.

Q44. Why does a Deccan posting require a multi-factor analysis?

A. Deccan geography automatically prevents any revenue B. all Deccan offices were identical C. only ethnicity determines a posting's value D. terrain, war, control, survey and collection affect effective yield

Answer: D. terrain, war, control, survey and collection affect effective yield

Explanation: The package rejects geographical determinism and ethnic reduction while recognising material constraints.

Q45. What did Shah Jahan inherit rather than invent?

A. the mansab-jagir framework with its Akbari foundations B. the standard date 1631 for Mumtaz's death C. the Safavid capture of Qandahar D. the 1657 illness

Answer: A. the mansab-jagir framework with its Akbari foundations

Explanation: Institutional inheritance is the point; the other choices are events or dates, not an administrative framework.

Q46. An imperial favour could advance a noble because:

A. the system was an anonymous modern civil service B. appointment and patronage were central to rank and access C. jagirs were legally automatic inheritances D. all ranks were elected by zamindars

Answer: B. appointment and patronage were central to rank and access

Explanation: Imperial appointment sat at the system's centre, alongside household and kin networks; election and automatic inheritance are anachronisms.

Q47. Why is legal non-heredity compatible with elite family continuity?

A. mansabs automatically passed to eldest sons B. no family could have court contact twice C. social capital, clients, training and reputation can transmit advantages D. rank depended only on land ownership

Answer: C. social capital, clients, training and reputation can transmit advantages

Explanation: The distinction between legal rule and social reproduction is exactly what the question tests.

Q48. Which is the best interpretation of a faction in 1657-58?

A. a biologically fixed ethnic camp B. a modern political party with a manifesto C. a village revenue unit D. a shifting patronage alignment around princes, rewards and survival

Answer: D. a shifting patronage alignment around princes, rewards and survival

Explanation: Faction is relational and temporal; fixed ethnicity and modern-party language distort the court setting.

Q49. Why did princely households matter to fiscal politics?

A. they could generate commands, rewards and competing claims on resources B. they removed princes from military affairs C. they converted all jagirs to khalisa D. they made succession automatic

Answer: A. they could generate commands, rewards and competing claims on resources

Explanation: Households are nodes of patronage and command, intensifying competition when the emperor is incapacitated.

Q50. The word 'suzerainty' is useful for the 1636 settlement only when it:

A. means equal modern state sovereignty B. distinguishes a hierarchical relation from complete annexation C. means no military pressure existed D. proves Bijapur and Golconda vanished

Answer: B. distinguishes a hierarchical relation from complete annexation

Explanation: A hierarchy may preserve internal courts; equating it with equality or disappearance loses the political form.

Q51. Why are campaign expenditure figures omitted here?

A. all Mughal campaigns were costless B. money did not exist in imperial administration C. the assigned sources do not securely establish a figure for this use D. cost has no analytical relevance

Answer: C. the assigned sources do not securely establish a figure for this use

Explanation: Cost is analytically relevant but must not be fabricated; named logistics and claims provide safer evidence.

Q52. A high jama in a newly acquired tract may still fail to support a mansabdar because:

A. jama is another word for realised cash B. transfer guarantees a full yield C. sawar removes all collection risk D. assessment and actual collection can diverge

Answer: D. assessment and actual collection can diverge

Explanation: The jama-hasil distinction drives the answer; neither transfer nor rank removes collection problems.

Q53. Which claim properly links month-scale and peasant pressure?

A. short-rated assignments could create extraction incentives but do not prove uniform oppression B. every month-rated jagir automatically caused famine C. the month-scale benefited cultivators by definition D. no local intermediary mattered

Answer: A. short-rated assignments could create extraction incentives but do not prove uniform oppression

Explanation: The language must be conditional and multi-actor; automatic famine and benefit claims exceed the evidence.

Q54. A careful Mains conclusion on 'golden age' should:

A. declare all subjects prosperous from monument size B. separate courtly magnificence from distributional and fiscal conditions C. deny any imperial capacity because Qandahar was lost D. treat revenue assessment as a welfare survey

Answer: B. separate courtly magnificence from distributional and fiscal conditions

Explanation: A graded conclusion preserves both evidence of capacity and limits of its social reach.

Q55. What does the 1638 capital project show most directly?

A. a city completed in twelve months B. a proof that every province paid full jama C. urban sovereignty and the court's capacity to organise a capital process D. the start of Aurangzeb's reign

Answer: C. urban sovereignty and the court's capacity to organise a capital process

Explanation: The project demonstrates coordination, but its timing and scale cannot be converted into unrelated fiscal or reign claims.

Q56. The best use of a schematic map in this topic is to:

A. supply precise survey measurements B. prove modern national borders C. replace chronology D. show strategic relationships while marking that it is not to scale

Answer: D. show strategic relationships while marking that it is not to scale

Explanation: Schematic maps aid spatial reasoning but cannot offer survey precision or erase temporal evidence.

Q57. Which formulation of the Deccan fiscal issue is strongest?

A. nominal resources and realisable revenue were separated by war, control and collection B. Deccan was simply rich on every measure C. Deccan was simply poor on every measure D. the issue was irrelevant to mansabdari

Answer: A. nominal resources and realisable revenue were separated by war, control and collection

Explanation: The source says inflated jama and low ratings can coexist; simple rich/poor labels miss the mechanism.

Q58. What does 'mansab inflation' most safely mean?

A. proof that every listed troop existed B. growth in nominal rank and military-salary claims C. a rise in food prices only D. the end of the mansab system

Answer: B. growth in nominal rank and military-salary claims

Explanation: Inflation is about paper claims and rank burden, not a direct census of soldiers or price movement.

Q59. Why could dagh/chehra not eliminate fraud entirely?

A. branding had no verification purpose B. all officers refused inspection C. a snapshot muster could be evaded by borrowed horses or temporary men D. chehra was a monument

Answer: C. a snapshot muster could be evaded by borrowed horses or temporary men

Explanation: The devices were meaningful checks, but the source's borrowed-contingent problem demonstrates their limits.

Q60. Which contrast is sound?

A. Akbar had no mansabdari and Shah Jahan invented it B. Jahangir created every jagir in 1657 C. Aurangzeb preceded Shah Jahan D. Akbar's foundation/systematisation versus Shah Jahan's mature adjustment under strain

Answer: D. Akbar's foundation/systematisation versus Shah Jahan's mature adjustment under strain

Explanation: The contrast preserves institutional continuity and changing pressure rather than inventing a Shah Jahan origin.

Q61. Which statement avoids a premature-decline narrative?

A. later jagirdari crisis matured under Aurangzeb and after, though roots were visible earlier B. month-scale means collapse occurred in 1628 C. no fiscal pressure existed before 1707 D. architecture alone explains all later events

Answer: A. later jagirdari crisis matured under Aurangzeb and after, though roots were visible earlier

Explanation: The right answer is chronological: roots and later maturation differ; both absolute alternatives are false.

Q62. Why is Qandahar relevant to this topic?

A. it was a Deccan month-rated jagir B. it tests logistics, princely command and the limits of frontier projection C. it proves all Safavid policy was domestic D. it eliminates the need to study Balkh

Answer: B. it tests logistics, princely command and the limits of frontier projection

Explanation: Qandahar is a bounded state-capacity case; it is neither a Deccan assignment nor a substitute for all frontier analysis.

Q63. Why does Balkh not equal permanent expansion?

A. Balkh was never entered by a Mughal force B. all expeditions yield permanent provinces C. retention and supply are separate from temporary battlefield success D. it was founded by Shah Jahan as a capital

Answer: C. retention and supply are separate from temporary battlefield success

Explanation: The distinction between tactical success and durable sustainability is the required reasoning.

Q64. Which source would most directly record a courtly appointment?

A. a modern satellite map B. a later traveller's general comparison C. a schematic revision diagram D. a Padshahnama-type court chronicle

Answer: D. a Padshahnama-type court chronicle

Explanation: Chronicles are highly useful for appointment and ceremonial claims, although they require genre criticism for broader social conclusions.

Remedial MCQs - original (correct options A-B-C-D x4)

Q65. A student calls Shah Jahan's reign a 'golden age' and concludes every subject prospered. What is the correction?

A. Courtly splendour does not establish universal prosperity B. Monuments prove every cultivator received equal income C. Jama is a direct welfare index D. No courtly wealth existed at all

Answer: A. Courtly splendour does not establish universal prosperity

Explanation: The error is a perspective jump from court evidence to every subject; the correction retains splendour while demanding social evidence.

Q66. A student says the Taj Mahal caused Mughal decline. What is the best response?

A. Architecture has no political-economic meaning B. A single monument cannot establish causation without wider fiscal comparison C. The Taj was built after 1707 D. All military costs were irrelevant

Answer: B. A single monument cannot establish causation without wider fiscal comparison

Explanation: The claim needs evidence of scale and competing demands; denying architecture's meaning or shifting dates does not repair causation.

Q67. Which date should replace the repository Part II's printed 1630 for Mumtaz Mahal's death?

A. 1628 B. 1638 C. 1631 D. 1657

Answer: C. 1631

Explanation: The remedy is precise: 1631 is standard; 1630 is retained only in the fact-risk note as a typo.

Q68. A student says sawar equals personal status. What is the correction?

A. Sawar denotes crown revenue; zat denotes actual hasil B. Both denote only city planning C. Zat is a Deccan treaty
D. Sawar denotes cavalry obligation; zat denotes personal status/pay grade

Answer: D. Sawar denotes cavalry obligation; zat denotes personal status/pay grade

Explanation: The two fields perform different work. The first option is the required pairwise correction.

Q69. A student says du-aspa sih-aspa automatically raises zat. What is the correction?

A. It increases specified cavalry obligation without itself raising zat B. It changes jama into hasil C. It is a Shahjahanabad market tax D. It makes jagirs hereditary

Answer: A. It increases specified cavalry obligation without itself raising zat

Explanation: The trap is to collapse military enhancement into personal rank; the other choices are unrelated vocabulary errors.

Q70. A student says Shah Jahan invented mansabdari and dagh. What is the correction?

A. Jahangir abolished all verification B. He inherited an Akbari system; dagh/chehra have earlier Alauddin-Sher Shah-Akbar provenance C. mansab began only after 1658 D. dagh is a type of mausoleum

Answer: B. He inherited an Akbari system; dagh/chehra have earlier Alauddin-Sher Shah-Akbar provenance

Explanation: The remedy combines institutional continuity with the correct control provenance; it rejects a Shah Jahan origin myth.

Q71. A student calls a jagir the noble's owned land. What is the correction?

A. It was always khalisa B. It was a uniform village caste title C. It was a transferable assignment of state revenue claim D. It had no link to service

Answer: C. It was a transferable assignment of state revenue claim

Explanation: This distinction prevents a freehold translation; service-linked assignment is the operative institutional idea.

Q72. A student equates jama with money actually collected. What is the correction?

A. Jama is cavalry, while hasil is rank B. both mean permanent property C. hasil is a type of monument D. Jama is assessed revenue, while hasil is realised collection

Answer: D. Jama is assessed revenue, while hasil is realised collection

Explanation: The answer restores the assessment-realisation gap that makes month ratings intelligible.

Q73. A student calls the month-scale a bonus for officers. What is the correction?

A. It reduced/scaled entitlement to an effective month rating B. It guaranteed twelve months' full yield C. It abolished cavalry service D. It created primogeniture

Answer: A. It reduced/scaled entitlement to an effective month rating

Explanation: It is an accounting adjustment for shortfall, not a premium allowance or constitutional rule.

Q74. A student says any month-rating proves the full later jagirdari crisis had already occurred. What is the correction?

A. It proves no strain existed B. It signals managed strain and roots, not the completed later crisis C. it refers only to art history D. it ends all transfers

Answer: B. It signals managed strain and roots, not the completed later crisis

Explanation: The temporal qualifier matters: a pressure-management device cannot be collapsed into the whole later crisis.

Q75. A student calls every Deccan jagir a rich reward. What is the correction?

A. Deccan had no administrative relevance B. all Deccan revenue was khalisa C. Source-bound cases show inflated jama and low effective ratings could make postings unattractive D. Qandahar lay in the Deccan

Answer: C. Source-bound cases show inflated jama and low effective ratings could make postings unattractive

Explanation: The remedy keeps the mismatch between assessed and usable return, rather than treating an expansive region as uniformly rich.

Q76. A student inserts an exact composition percentage without citation. What is the correction?

A. Percentages become valid if written in bold B. all categories were legally identical C. no historian may discuss composition D. State the trend or supply a dataset, date, denominator and method

Answer: D. State the trend or supply a dataset, date, denominator and method

Explanation: Precision requires a defined population and method; typography cannot convert an unsupported figure into evidence.

Q77. A student says Mughal nobility was legally hereditary. What is the correction?

A. Mansabs were imperial grants, though family networks reproduced advantage socially B. Every son automatically inherited zat C. families were absent from court D. jagirdars elected successors

Answer: A. Mansabs were imperial grants, though family networks reproduced advantage socially

Explanation: Legal non-heredity and social reproduction must be held together; either extreme loses the institutional nuance.

Q78. A student says succession factions were fixed ethnic camps. What is the correction?

A. Origin labels never existed B. Alignments shifted with patrons, princes, rewards and military circumstances C. all nobles avoided the war D. only zamindars chose emperors

Answer: B. Alignments shifted with patrons, princes, rewards and military circumstances

Explanation: Origin categories existed but did not mechanically determine allegiance; patronage logic is the closer explanation.

Q79. A student says the 1657-58 war instantly destroyed the empire. What is the correction?

A. It was a peaceful primogeniture transfer B. it occurred before Shah Jahan's reign C. It violently reconfigured the command centre without instant institutional collapse D. it was only a monument dispute

Answer: C. It violently reconfigured the command centre without instant institutional collapse

Explanation: The war demonstrates transfer vulnerability and factional stakes, but administrative structures did not vanish overnight.

Q80. A response turns Topic 21 into a full account of Akbar, Shivaji and Mughal culture. What is the correction?

A. Repeat every adjacent package word for word B. omit mansab history altogether C. move all chronology to Topic 24 D. Use cross-links: retain foundations, bridges and boundaries without duplicating owner topics

Answer: D. Use cross-links: retain foundations, bridges and boundaries without duplicating owner topics

Explanation: The topic needs the Akbar-Jahangir foundations and later bridges, but ownership boundaries protect clarity and causal precision.

PART III - ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Mains 1. 10 marks | 'Shah Jahan's reign was both the zenith of Mughal grandeur and a period of structural strain.' Discuss.

Directive alignment: weigh two propositions, then give a graded verdict.

Model solution: Shah Jahan's reign (1628-1658) was a peak of visible imperial capacity, but that capacity did not remove the growing gap between revenue claims and service claims. The correct verdict is not 'golden age or crisis'; it is grandeur alongside managed strain.

First, the court could coordinate exceptional material and political display. The Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Jama Masjid and the 1638 Shahjahanabad project required workshops, labour, materials and court direction. They demonstrate organisational reach and a ruler-centred language of sovereignty. The 1633 Ahmadnagar outcome and 1636 Deccan settlement similarly show that the state could combine force and hierarchy.

Second, the fiscal-military system exposed limits. The Satish Chandra-based index in the assigned material moves from 100 (1595) to about 176 (1656-57), but mansab and high-rank claims grew faster. The month-scale acknowledged that a nominal twelve-month jagir could produce only an eight-, six- or lower-month effective return. This constrained pay and remount capacity. Deccan three-to-four-month cases make the mismatch particularly clear, though war, terrain and collection problems—not merely fraud—must explain it.

Finally, Balkh (1646-47) and Qandahar's loss in 1649 separate mobilisation from durable strategic success; the 1657-58 succession war exposed transfer vulnerability. Thus grandeur was real, but it was unevenly sustained. The roots of later jagirdari pressure were visible without making Shah Jahan's reign an already collapsed state.

Why this earns marks: It answers both sides, names monuments, revenue evidence and campaigns, explains a mechanism, and qualifies the later-crisis claim.

Mains 2. 15 marks | Examine how the composition and recruitment of the Mughal ruling class under Shah Jahan combined integration with competition.

Directive alignment: explain composition, recruitment and the two-sided consequence.

Model solution: The Mughal ruling class under Shah Jahan was a composite service elite rather than a homogeneous ethnicity or a modern civil service. Its diversity strengthened imperial reach but made rank, jagir and princely patronage intensely competitive.

Its core consisted of high mansabdars and household-connected servants linked to the emperor through rank, command, jagir and favour. Court language included Turanis, Iranis, Hindustani/Indian Muslims including Shaikhzada lineages, Rajputs, Afghans, Deccanis and other entrants. This is not a rigid census: labels can reflect origin, migration, regional association or political network. The safest scholarly trend is a widening Indian element across the Akbar-Jahangir-Shah Jahan sequence while immigrant groups remained significant; no uncited percentage should be used.

Recruitment mixed competence with patronage. Military usefulness, administrative skill, frontier knowledge, recommendation, kinship and household attachment could advance a person. Rajput houses, including Kachhwahas, gained honour, rank and service opportunity, but house-specific calculation prevents a claim of uniform Rajput loyalty.

Shahji Bhonsale is a bounded Deccan example: elite incorporation does not equal mass Maratha integration.

The system integrated local links and talent into an imperial hierarchy. Yet formal non-heredity did not erase social reproduction: families retained clients, reputations and court familiarity. When rank and good jagirs were scarce, those networks became sites of competition. In 1657-58, uncertainty over which prince would allocate offices transformed ordinary patronage into factional alignment.

Therefore diversity was a governing resource and a structural risk. It should be analysed through changing patrons and incentives, not fixed ethnic camps.

Why this earns marks: It defines the object, names groups with caution, supplies Rajput/Maratha evidence, explains recruitment and connects composition to succession politics.

Mains 3. 15 marks | Trace the evolution of the mansabdari system from Akbar to Shah Jahan. Was Shah Jahan an innovator or an adjuster?

Directive alignment: trace continuity and change, then classify Shah Jahan accurately.

Model solution: Shah Jahan was principally an adjuster of a mature mansabdari framework, not its inventor. Akbar's system linked graded service to imperial dependence; Jahangir and Shah Jahan adapted its military and fiscal operation as claims became heavier.

Under Akbar, the mature dual rank of c.1595-96 separated **zat**, personal status and pay grade, from **sawar**, cavalry obligation. This distinction enabled the centre to rank men while specifying service. Akbar also systematised **dagh** and **chehra** within a longer control lineage: Alauddin Khalji had used branding/descriptive control and Sher Shah revived/adapted it. Their purpose was to reduce divergence between paper contingent and actual force.

Jahangir's **du-aspa sih-aspa** is the next adjustment. It could double or triple specified cavalry obligation without raising **zat**. This device must not be described as doubling the whole rank. It shows how the state could enhance military claims without a corresponding rise in personal status.

Shah Jahan inherited this grammar. His source-grounded contingent ratios and muster adjustments require contextual reading rather than a universal formula. More important was the tension between rising mansab/salary claims and jagir realisation. Month-rating scaled entitlement to effective revenue, while **dagh/chehra** still confronted evasion such as temporary borrowed horses.

Thus Shah Jahan's reign demonstrates mature adjustment under pressure: flexible enough to maintain service and imperial dependence, but vulnerable where nominal rank outran reliable support. The later jagirdari crisis intensified this tension; it should not be retrojected as a completed outcome.

Why this earns marks: The answer traces all three reigns, corrects **dagh** provenance and **du-aspa/zat** traps, and reaches a nuanced innovator-versus-adjuster verdict.

Mains 4. 10 marks | Explain du-aspa sih-aspa and the month-scale. How did each address a different Mughal problem?

Directive alignment: define both devices and compare their functions.

Model solution: **Du-aspa sih-aspa** and the month-scale operated at different points in the Mughal service system. The first adjusted the military obligation; the second adjusted fiscal entitlement to effective jagir value.

Du-aspa sih-aspa appears under Jahangir in the assigned source tradition. It allowed a specified **sawar** obligation to be doubled or tripled without raising the mansabdar's **zat**. Its function was to obtain additional cavalry capacity while retaining the distinction between personal rank and service duty. It did not double the whole mansab or transform status.

The month-scale belongs to the fiscal response visible under Shah Jahan. A jagir nominally valued at twelve months could yield an eight-, six- or lower-month effective return; pay and **sawar** support were scaled accordingly. The source illustration of Rs 40, Rs 30 and Rs 25 must be treated as a category-specific **sawar-pay** example, not a universal schedule. Deccan three-to-four-month ratings show why the device could generate discontent and weaken remount capacity.

Both devices show an adaptive state: one calibrated demand for cavalry, the other calibrated claims to revenue realisation. Neither proves automatic collapse. Their combined significance is that military promise depended upon fiscal support.

Why this earns marks: It defines terms, distinguishes *zat* from *sawar*, explains the accounting mechanism and avoids turning examples into universal data.

Mains 5. 15 marks | Distinguish *jagir*, *jama* and *hasil*. Analyse how their relationship shaped Mughal political economy.

Directive alignment: define each term and move from vocabulary to causal analysis.

Model solution: A *jagir* was a service-linked assignment of a state revenue claim; *jama* was assessed or estimated revenue; *hasil* was actual realised collection. Their relationship explains why Mughal political economy cannot be reduced to a map of privately owned estates.

The *jagirdar* held an imperial assignment, normally transferable, rather than unrestricted ownership of land or province. This differed from the locally rooted and variable position of a *zamindar*. Transfer helped retain central leverage, though short tenure could create incentives for intensive extraction and competition for better assignments. *Khalisa*, by contrast, referred to revenue retained for the crown.

Jama represented a fiscal estimate or claim, whereas *hasil* recorded realisation. A gap could arise from optimistic assessment, survey problems, war, incomplete control, collection cost, resistance or disrupted cultivation. Therefore a *jagir* whose paper *jama* appeared adequate could still fail to fund a full annual entitlement. The month-scale translated that gap into effective months and adjusted salary/service support.

The political consequence was triangular. The centre sought to reward and bind *mansabdars*; *jagirdars* sought viable returns and remount resources; *zamindars* and cultivators faced local negotiation and revenue pressure. The argument should not assume uniform oppression or treat *jama* as GDP. Rather, it identifies a system in which central claims, local conditions and service obligations were continuously reconciled.

Why this earns marks: It gives exact definitions, distinguishes *jagirdar* from *zamindar*, names mechanisms for the *jama-hasil* gap and links vocabulary to incentives without overclaiming.

Mains 6. 20 marks | Analyse the Deccan as a source of both imperial opportunity and fiscal pressure during Shah Jahan's reign.

Directive alignment: balance opportunity and pressure, with a bounded Deccan chronology.

Model solution: Under Shah Jahan, the Deccan was not merely a frontier to be coloured on an imperial map. It offered forts, routes, tributary possibilities, local military resources and nominal revenue, while simultaneously imposing the costs of war, control and uncertain collection. Its political economy helps explain why expansion could increase both resources and fiscal pressure.

On the opportunity side, the end of Ahmadnagar's Nizam Shahi line at Daulatabad in 1633 and the 1636 settlement with Bijapur and Golconda displayed real Mughal capacity to combine conquest, suzerainty and negotiation. The Deccan also offered access to local knowledge and mobile military labour. Shahji Bhonsale's service trajectory is a limited example of elite movement across Deccani and Mughal worlds. Such incorporation broadened imperial options, but it must not be exaggerated into stable mass Maratha integration.

The pressure side lies in the conversion of nominal resource into usable yield. The assigned Satish Chandra-based material notes highly inflated Deccan *jama* and cases rated at only three to four months. This mismatch can arise from terrain, distance, warfare, incomplete control, survey limits and collection costs, not only official deceit. A short-rated assignment could reduce effective income and remount capacity, generate competition for better postings, and intensify pressure on intermediaries and producers.

The renewed interventions of 1656-57 reinforce the point that a settlement did not eliminate claims. Expansion added garrisons, commanders and princely commands even where it added revenue prospects. Therefore Deccan policy was a managed bargain between strategy and fiscal realisation, not a simple gain or loss. The mature crisis belongs later, but Shah Jahan's Deccan shows its important preconditions.

Why this earns marks: It uses 1633, 1636, Shahji and 3-4 month evidence; explains a multi-causal mechanism; and keeps Topic 23's later narrative outside the answer.

Mains 7. 15 marks | 'Court grandeur under Shah Jahan was a political economy, not merely an aesthetic achievement.' Discuss.

Directive alignment: explain political and economic mechanisms while qualifying causal claims.

Model solution: Shah Jahan's court grandeur was political economy because monuments and ceremonial centres mobilised resources, organised skilled work, structured urban demand and represented a hierarchy of sovereignty. It was not simply aesthetic display, but neither can it be treated as a self-evident cause of fiscal collapse.

The Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Jama Masjid and Shahjahanabad required materials, transport, labour, workshops, design and supervision. The 1638 foundation/transfer process for Shahjahanabad made the court's presence spatially legible through fortress, mosque, markets and circulation. These projects demonstrate a state and court able to concentrate demand and make political authority visible. Court consumption could support artisans and suppliers, especially within urban markets.

Yet the distributional question remains. The surplus financing courtly consumption was gathered in a hierarchical revenue order in which jagirdars, zamindars and cultivators occupied unequal positions. Court splendour does not prove universal prosperity. Nor does the Taj Mahal alone demonstrate a causal route to Mughal decline: such a claim would need comparative evidence on spending, revenue realisation, warfare and jagir claims that cannot be inferred from the monument itself.

A current static link is urban heritage: the accessible SRDC Jama Masjid precinct material discusses streets, facilities and a visual/physical Red Fort link. It cannot be converted into a dated six-month CA claim or evidence about seventeenth-century accounts. Thus grandeur is best read as material sovereignty embedded in a wider extractive and productive system.

Why this earns marks: It makes monuments analytical, uses Shahjahanabad precisely, includes craft/market and extraction dimensions, and explicitly rejects a single-cause fallacy.

Mains 8. 20 marks | How did the 1657-58 succession struggle reveal the strengths and vulnerabilities of Mughal ruling-class politics?

Directive alignment: connect ruling class and succession with a balanced institutional verdict.

Model solution: The 1657-58 succession struggle revealed the Mughal ruling class as both an integrative instrument of empire and a vulnerable patronage order when sovereign allocation became uncertain. The illness of Shah Jahan did not create faction from nothing; it raised the stakes of an elite structure already organised around rank, household, command and jagir.

Its strength lay in the empire's ability to mobilise through diverse service networks. High mansabdars, Rajput houses, Turani and Irani migrants, Hindustani Muslim lineages, Afghans, Deccanis and other entrants could be linked to an emperor through mansab, reward and command. Princes also possessed regional bases: Dara's courtly position, Shuja's Bengal, Aurangzeb's Deccan and Murad's Gujarat supplied potential manpower and resources. Dharmat and Samugarh in 1658 demonstrate that elite command and regional mobilisation were real capacities.

The same structure was vulnerable because the polity had no fixed primogeniture rule. When Shah Jahan's illness made the future allocator of office uncertain, nobles calculated survival, reward, kin ties and immediate military prospects. Alignments were not rigid ethnic camps; they were shifting patronage choices. The later battles of Khajwa and Deorai, Murad's removal and Shah Jahan's confinement show that military victory had to be converted into control of the imperial centre.

The war did not instantly dissolve administration or revenue. It did, however, expose a transfer mechanism dependent on personal power rather than a settled rule. A graded conclusion is therefore appropriate: the composite ruling class made empire governable in normal times, but its competitive patronage networks could become a vector of intense conflict at dynastic transition.

Why this earns marks: It gives chronology, princes and battles, rejects ethnic determinism, explains incentives and distinguishes violent transfer from instant collapse.

Mains 9. 15 marks | Evaluate Padshahnama, administrative data, monuments and travellers as sources for Shah Jahan's reign.

Directive alignment: evaluate source reach and limitations rather than merely list sources.

Model solution: Shah Jahan's reign is best reconstructed by triangulating genres, because each source type illuminates a different register of imperial life and carries a different silence.

Padshahnama and related court chronicles are strong for ceremony, campaigns, appointments, titulature and the court's claim to orderly sovereignty. They can date and frame elite actions, but their legitimising purpose may understate failure, coercion and social suffering. Amal-i-Salih and Shah Jahan Nama traditions require the same attention to genre and proximity.

Administrative tables and mansab/jagir data are indispensable for patterns in rank, assessed revenue and assignment. They make the jama-versus-mansab problem visible. But nominal categories are not automatically actual cash, effective troops or a complete population. The 100/about 122/about 176 jama index must therefore be called an assessed-revenue index from a cited modern synthesis, not GDP.

Monuments such as the Taj Mahal and Red Fort reveal material coordination, ideology and elite demand. They cannot by themselves calculate fiscal health. Travellers such as Tavernier, Bernier and Manucci supply observations on court, trade and cities, but their outsider vantage, comparative rhetoric and chronology must be checked; Bernier's later observations cannot be transparently universalised for Shah Jahan.

Thus the best method is a source-reach matrix: chronicle for claim and appointment; record for administrative pattern; monument for material sovereignty; traveller for situated observation. Agreement strengthens an inference, while contradiction should be explained rather than erased.

Why this earns marks: It evaluates four evidence types, gives specific uses and limits, treats the index correctly, and turns source criticism into a method.

Mains 10. 20 marks | 'The fiscal pressures of Shah Jahan's reign were real, but the language of inevitable collapse is misleading.' Evaluate.

Directive alignment: establish pressure, test inevitability, and give a time-sensitive verdict.

Model solution: Fiscal pressures under Shah Jahan were real because the Mughal service system had to reconcile expanding rank and cavalry claims with unevenly realised revenue. Yet 'inevitable collapse' is misleading because the state still adjusted, mobilised and represented authority effectively; the mature jagirdari crisis belongs to a later chronology.

The pressure is visible in three linked facts. First, the assigned Satish Chandra-based jama index rises from 100 in 1595 to approximately 122 in 1627 and approximately 176 in 1656-57, while the source describes mansab/rank claims as growing faster. Second, jama was an assessment, not hasil. Hence a jagir with a twelve-month paper valuation might produce an eight-, six- or lower-month effective return. The month-scale reduced entitlement and service support to that rating; the source's Rs 40/30/25 illustration must remain category-specific. Third, Deccan cases rated at three to four months show how war, terrain, control and collection could make nominal expansion fiscally thin.

These pressures had consequences: weaker remount capacity, demand for better assignments, factional patronage and possible pressure on local revenue channels. Frontier campaigns in Balkh and Qandahar added logistical demands, while 1657-58 made office allocation politically explosive.

However, the same evidence shows adaptation. The month-scale was a management device; dagh/chehra and contingent rules sought verification; the court still coordinated monuments and capital-making; Deccan settlements and military mobilisation remained possible. Neither a monument nor a month rating proves collapse.

The best conclusion is chronological: Shah Jahan's reign incubated claim-resource tension within a functioning imperial order. Later extended war and post-Aurangzeb conditions intensified the crisis, but inevitability should not be read backward.

Why this earns marks: It builds a mechanism from terminology and evidence, gives counter-evidence of adaptation, and ends with a precise, non-deterministic chronology.

Clean workbook close

Final self-check before a timed answer: Define every Persian term; write the source/date alongside every number; distinguish jama from hasil; distinguish zat from sawar; distinguish a jagir assignment from land ownership; and end with a graded verdict. The correct answer is rarely the grandest claim. It is the one that connects a named fact to a mechanism and states what the evidence cannot establish.

Thirty-second evidence audit: If using a number, name its category. The 100/about 122/about 176 series is assessed jama, not GDP or cash; the Rs 40/30/25 illustration is a cited sawar-pay example, not a universal income table; three-to-four-month Deccan ratings are context-bound. If using a source, name its reach. A Padshahnama can establish a courtly appointment or claim of order; it cannot by itself prove social conditions everywhere. If using a monument, state mobilisation and sovereignty, then avoid converting it into a total expenditure account. These small qualifiers turn factual recall into examiner-grade historical reasoning.

Final eight-point scoring card: (1) Did the introduction answer the exact directive rather than merely name Shah Jahan? (2) Did the answer distinguish **zat** from **sawar** and nominal force from effective force? (3) Did it use **jagir**, **jama** and **hasil** in their separate meanings? (4) Did every numerical illustration retain its source and scope? (5) Did Deccan discussion include war, terrain, control and collection rather than a single moral explanation? (6) Did architecture function as evidence of mobilisation, without becoming a single-cause decline claim? (7) Did succession explain patronage calculation without fixed ethnic camps? (8) Did the conclusion say whether the evidence supports visible capacity, managed strain or both?

Timed synthesis drill: In three minutes, draw two columns headed *capacity* and *strain*. Under capacity write 1636 settlement, capital-making, monument coordination and rank-based integration. Under strain write jama-hasil gap, month rating, Deccan low realisation, frontier sustainability and contested succession. In the centre write: **the same service-fiscal architecture enabled imperial display while creating claim-resource tension**. This sentence is not a substitute for evidence; it is a memory spine that prevents the answer from separating mansabdari, jagir, campaign and court into unrelated paragraphs.

Last mental comparison: Akbar's mature framework supplied the basic vocabulary of rank and verification; Jahangir's du-aspa sih-aspa demonstrates a targeted adjustment to cavalry demand; Shah Jahan's month-scale demonstrates an adjustment to effective fiscal support. Put these beside, not against, the Deccan settlement, Balkh and Qandahar. A state may mobilise impressive campaigns and coordinate monuments while still finding that nominal assessment does not convert evenly into usable revenue. This is why the most defensible final line is neither 'perfect golden age' nor 'inevitable collapse': Shah Jahan's imperial order retained substantial capacity while managing a developing claim-resource mismatch.